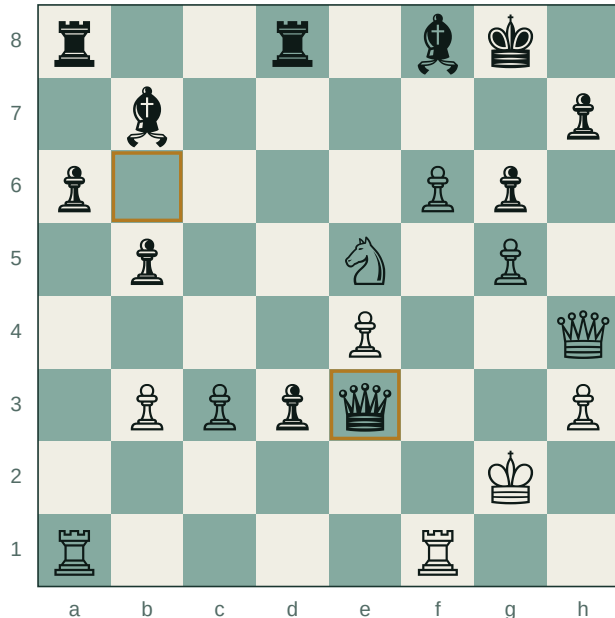


Mate in three: White, move 31

Mate in three

White to move



Previous move: 30...Qe3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

31. f7+ Kh8 32. Nxg6+ Kg7 33. Qh6#

31.f7+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **31...Kh8**.

32.Nxg6+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From g6 it attacks king on h8 and bishop on f8. Recorded reply: **32...Kg7**.

33.Qh6# Mate: queen on h6 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on g7. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on h6. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not stop at a promising check. The final mating position must still be legal after every intervening move.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Longer mating lines require accurate visualization. Track the king's square, opened lines, and every sacrificed piece through the entire sequence.

HOW TO LOOK

Work backward from a mating pattern, then calculate forward with the opponent choosing the strongest defense.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: bishop on b7 and queen on e3. Check for tactical protection.